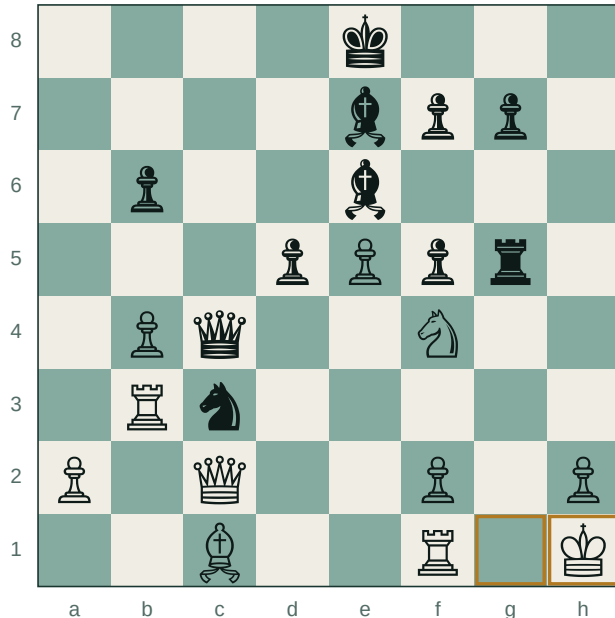


# Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 30

Loose-piece tactics

## Black to move



Previous move: 30.Kh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 30...Qxf1#

**30...Qxf1#** Mate: queen on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

## CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

## HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c2 and rook on f1. Check for tactical protection.